PROFESSIONAL PROFILE · ANTHROPOLOGY FACULTY

Jessica Marshall

Adjunct Anthropology Instructor, Sacramento City College
Professor of Anthropology, Cañada College

Compiled October 2, 2026 from public sources

AT A GLANCE

Discipline	Anthropology, with a graduate specialty in **visual anthropology** (photography and ethnographic film)
Current roles	Adjunct (part-time) anthropology instructor, **Sacramento City College** (Los Rios Community College District) Professor of Anthropology, **Cañada College**, Redwood City (San Mateo County Community College District)
Degrees	B.A. Anthropology, B.A. Photography, B.A. Journalism — California State University, Sacramento M.A. Visual Anthropology — University of Kent, England
Teaches	Cultural Anthropology, Biological (Physical) Anthropology, Archaeology, Ethnographic Film
Experience	About 21 years of college teaching; on the Cañada College faculty since 2007
Known for	Leading faculty-led study-abroad programs in Egypt, Italy, Australia, Belize and Japan

Overview

Jessica Marshall is a community-college anthropologist whose career centers on teaching introductory anthropology across its subfields and on taking students abroad to study culture first-hand. She is a full Professor of Anthropology at Cañada College in Redwood City and also teaches anthropology at Sacramento City College (SCC), where she appears in the college's employee directory under the Anthropology department.

Her academic training is unusually visual. Alongside an undergraduate anthropology degree she earned separate bachelor's degrees in photography and journalism, then completed a master's in **visual anthropology** in England — the branch of the discipline that uses photography and film both to record cultural life and to analyze how cultures represent themselves. That thread runs straight through to her current teaching, which includes a course in ethnographic film.

Education

Degree	Field	Institution
M.A.	Visual Anthropology	University of Kent, Canterbury, England
B.A.	Anthropology	California State University, Sacramento
B.A.	Photography	California State University, Sacramento
B.A.	Journalism	California State University, Sacramento

- As an undergraduate she studied abroad in **Florence, Italy** — an experience she cites as the origin of her commitment to study-abroad teaching.

- No doctorate was found in public sources. A master's degree is the standard minimum qualification for anthropology faculty in the California Community Colleges system.

Anthropological Focus & Research Interests

Visual anthropology (trained specialty)

Her M.A. specialization and her degrees in photography and journalism point to a core interest in documenting and interpreting culture through images. She teaches **ANTH 200: Ethnographic Film**, which examines how filmmakers and anthropologists portray other ways of life, and she has taught it on location abroad (Florence 2024; Japan 2026).

Four-field generalist teaching

Her course load spans the major subfields of American anthropology: cultural anthropology, biological/physical anthropology (human evolution, genetics, primates, the fossil record), and archaeology.

Experiential, place-based learning

For the 2026 Japan program she described plans to "tie place into" her anthropology class so students can apply course concepts directly to their experiences abroad. She has argued that studying abroad allows deeper understanding of other cultures, sharper critical thinking about the world, and a better sense of one's own place in it.

Culture and environment

With Cañada biology professor Carol Rhodes she co-led *Sustainable Life in Belize: Culture and Ecosystems*, an interdisciplinary program pairing anthropology with ecology.

Note on research activity. Her public footprint is teaching-centered. No funded research program, ongoing fieldwork project, or research lab was found in public sources; her applied ethnographic and visual work appears to be channeled mainly into teaching and study-abroad programs. This is typical of California community-college faculty, whose positions are teaching-focused.

Courses Taught

Course	Where	What it covers
ANTH 300 — Biological Anthropology	Sacramento City College (offered online)	The science of biological anthropology: the scientific method, genetics and inheritance, natural selection and evolution, modern human variation, living primates, and fossil evidence for human evolution.
ANTH 310 — Cultural Anthropology	Sacramento City College (offered online)	Comparative study of human cultures; a core requirement of SCC's Anthropology associate degree.
Introduction to Cultural Anthropology	Cañada College	Introductory cultural anthropology; also taught abroad (Florence).
Introduction to Physical / Biological Anthropology	Cañada College	Human evolution and biology; also taught abroad (Florence).
Archaeology	Cañada College	Methods and findings of archaeology and the study of past societies.
ANTH 200 — Ethnographic Film	Cañada College / SMCCD study abroad	Film as a tool and object of anthropological study; taught in Florence (2024) and Japan (2026).

SCC course numbers are confirmed through student reviews and SCC's catalog. Cañada course titles come from a Skyline College news profile; exact Cañada course numbers other than ANTH 200 were not confirmed.

Study Abroad & Global Teaching

College years	Studied abroad in Florence, Italy, as an undergraduate.
2011	Led a group of Cañada College students on an intensive two-week study-abroad program in **Egypt**.
Spring 2017	San Mateo County Community College District faculty lead for the Northern California Study Abroad Consortium (NCSAC) semester in **Florence, Italy**.
Undated	Has taught anthropology in **Australia**, and co-led *Sustainable Life in Belize: Culture and Ecosystems* in **Belize** with biologist Carol Rhodes.
Spring 2024	Faculty member for the NCSAC semester in **Florence**, teaching Cultural Anthropology, Biological Anthropology and Ethnographic Film. The program's course list also included Italian Life and Culture.
Summer 2026	Faculty leader for the SMCCD **Japan** program (June 12–27, 2026), teaching ANTH 200 Ethnographic Film alongside an Interaction Design course (MART 393).

Publications & Scholarly Output

No published papers were found. Targeted web searches, including ones aimed at ResearchGate, Academia.edu and Google Scholar listings, did not turn up any peer-reviewed articles, books, book chapters, or conference papers by this Jessica Marshall. Her M.A. at Kent would have required a dissertation or project, but it does not appear to be available online.

Her documented professional output is instead pedagogical: course design (including ethnographic film), the study-abroad programs listed above, and a listing in the American Anthropological Association's *AnthroGuide* directory of anthropology programs and faculty.

Watch out for name mix-ups

Several other people with similar names publish in nearby fields. Their work should **not** be attributed to her:

- **Jessica Marshall, Ph.D.** — learning-sciences scholar (Northwestern University; National Academy of Education/Spencer fellow) who wrote on teaching about reparations.
- **Jessica Marshall** — faculty member at Parsons School of Design, The New School.
- **Jessica Marshall** — science journalist who writes for *Discover* magazine.
- **John Marshall** and **Lorna Marshall** — the visual-anthropology filmmaker and ethnographer known for work with the Ju/'hoansi of southern Africa. They come up constantly in visual-anthropology searches; no source links them to her.
- **Fiona Marshall** — archaeologist at Washington University in St. Louis.

Student Perspectives

Student reviews on RateMyProfessors are mixed and come from a small, self-selected group. For her SCC listing (about 10 ratings when this was compiled, averaging roughly 2.5 out of 5), reviewers describe the online ANTH 300 and ANTH 310 coursework as manageable, with practice quizzes and extra-credit opportunities. Some also report slow email replies and a strict attendance or drop policy in online sections. Separate listings exist for her Cañada College teaching.

Professional Contact

Cañada College	marshallj@smccd.edu · (650) 306-3311 · Building 13, Room 313 4200 Farm Hill Blvd., Redwood City, CA
Sacramento City College	Listed in the SCC employee directory (Anthropology); scc.losrios.edu/about-us/contact-us/employee-directory

Verification Notes

- The SCC employee directory and the Cañada College faculty page could not be opened directly from the research environment. Details from those pages come from search-engine extracts of them.
- Her **adjunct** status at SCC comes from the request for this profile. Public sources confirm she is listed with SCC's Anthropology department and holds a full professorship at Cañada.
- "About 21 years" of teaching comes from the SMCCD Japan 2026 program page. The 2007 start date at Cañada comes from the college catalog's faculty listing.
- No dates were found for the Australia and Belize programs.
- A RateMyProfessors listing also exists for a "Jessica Marshall" in anthropology at Sierra College (Nevada County campus). It may be the same person, but this could not be confirmed.

Sources

1. Sacramento City College — Employee Directory: Jessica Marshall. scc.losrios.edu/about-us/contact-us/employee-directory/employee?id=1091054
2. Cañada College — Anthropology, Meet the Faculty: Jessica Marshall (Professor). canadacollege.edu/anthropology/meetthefaculty.php
3. Cañada College Catalog — Faculty and Other Academic Personnel. catalog.canadacollege.edu/current/campus-directory/faculty.php
4. San Mateo County CCD Study Abroad — Japan: Summer 2026. smccd.edu/studyabroad/programs/shortterm/japan.php
5. Skyline College — "Students Prepare to Study Abroad in Florence, Italy in Spring 2024." skylineshines.skylinecollege.edu
6. The Skyline View — "Expand your global knowledge" (April 25, 2016). theskylineview.com/news/2016/04/25/expand-your-global-knowledge/
7. American Anthropological Association — AnthroGuide: Jessica Marshall. guide.americananthro.org/74937/Jessica-Marshall
8. Sacramento City College — Anthropology program and ANTH 300/310 course information. scc.losrios.edu/academics/programs-and-majors/anthropology
9. RateMyProfessors — Jessica Marshall at Sacramento City College (ratemyprofessors.com/professor/2292151) and at Cañada College (ratemyprofessors.com/professor/2063898).
10. Northern California Study Abroad Consortium — Florence program materials (AIFS / Santa Rosa JC / American River College).